

THE FUTURIST'S STRATEGY CONE™

A Human-Controlled Governance Framework
for Agentic AI in Internal Audit

4 STAGES: Risk → Audit → Evidence → Reporting



CONCEPTUAL RESEARCH FRAMEWORK



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Creator of
THE FUTURIST'S
STRATEGY CONE™



Designed for Boards, CFOs & CAEs
to Govern Agentic AI with Confidence



AI Enhances Capability.
Humans Maintain Accountability.



Explore the
Framework
Scan to learn more



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DM **"CONE"** for Framework

THE FUTURIST'S STRATEGY CONE™ V3.0

**Enterprise Governance Blueprint
for Agentic AI in Internal Audit**

Conceptual Research Edition

Developed by Adnan Shamim

Executive Statement

The Futurist's Strategy Cone™ V3.0 is an independent enterprise governance blueprint designed to support the responsible adoption of Agentic AI within Internal Audit.

The framework establishes a human-controlled governance model that integrates governance, risk management, audit execution, evidence validation, reporting, technical controls, and continuous oversight while preserving professional judgment and accountability.

The framework is technology-neutral and intended to complement—not replace—existing corporate governance, regulatory obligations, and professional standards.

Core Principle

AI Enhances Capability. Humans Maintain Accountability.

AI Works. Humans Decide.

Vision

To enable organizations to safely adopt Agentic AI while ensuring governance decisions remain transparent, explainable, auditable, secure, and accountable.

Mission

Provide Boards, Audit Committees, Internal Audit Functions, Risk Leaders, and AI Governance professionals with a practical governance blueprint for implementing Human-Controlled Agentic AI.

Scope

This blueprint is intended for:

- Boards of Directors
- Audit Committees
- Chief Audit Executives (CAE)
- Heads of Internal Audit
- Internal Audit Managers
- Internal Auditors
- AI Governance Teams
- Enterprise Risk Management
- Compliance Functions
- Information Security
- Technology Leadership

Guiding Principles

1. Human Accountability
2. Professional Judgment
3. Explainability
4. Transparency
5. Auditability
6. Evidence Integrity
7. Privacy Protection
8. Information Security
9. Regulatory Alignment
10. Continuous Improvement

THE FUTURIST'S STRATEGY CONE™

Stage 1 – Risk

Human Authority

Head of Internal Audit

AI Role

- Risk identification
- Trend analysis
- Emerging risk monitoring
- Risk heat maps
- Risk prioritization support

Human Control Gate

Only authorized human professionals determine:

- Risk Appetite
- Risk Rating
- Risk Acceptance
- Final Risk Assessment

Stage 2 – Audit

Human Authority

Internal Audit Manager

AI Role

- Continuous auditing
- Data analytics
- Exception detection
- Pattern recognition
- Audit testing

Human Control Gate

AI may recommend findings.

Only human auditors determine:

- Audit findings
- Control deficiencies
- Audit conclusions

Stage 3 – Evidence

Human Authority

Internal Audit Team

AI Role

- Document review
- Contract analysis
- OCR
- Evidence matching
- Evidence summarization

Human Control Gate

Every AI-generated output should be:

- Traceable
- Verifiable
- Supported by evidence
- Reviewed by human auditors

Stage 4 – Reporting

Human Authority

Head of Internal Audit

AI Role

- Draft reports
- Executive summaries
- Dashboards
- Visual analytics

Human Control Gate

AI cannot issue:

- Audit Opinion
- Assurance Opinion
- Final Report Approval

Only authorized human professionals approve final reports.

Enterprise AI Control Requirements

Mandatory Controls

- Human approval checkpoints
- Segregation of duties
- Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)
- Audit logging
- Evidence traceability
- Data governance
- Security monitoring
- Change management

Recommended Controls

Organizations should consider implementing:

- Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)
- Confidence scoring
- Drift monitoring
- Explainability tools
- Zero Data Retention (where appropriate)
- Red Team testing
- Governance dashboards
- Continuous AI monitoring

Enterprise Governance Lifecycle

Strategy

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Risk Assessment

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Governance Approval

,

Solution Design

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Development

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Testing

,

Deployment

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Monitoring

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Internal Audit

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Continuous Improvement

Enterprise Governance Roles (RACI)

Role	Responsibility
Board	Governance Oversight
Audit Committee	Governance Monitoring
Chief Audit Executive	Accountability
Head of Internal Audit	Strategic Oversight
Internal Audit Manager	Audit Supervision
Internal Audit Team	Evidence Validation
AI Governance	AI Governance
Risk Management	Enterprise Risk
Compliance	Regulatory Compliance
Information Security	Cybersecurity
IT	Technology Operations
Legal	Legal Review

AI Governance Maturity Model

Level 1

Manual Internal Audit

Level 2

AI-Assisted Internal Audit

Level 3

Controlled Agentic AI

Level 4

Enterprise AI Governance

Level 5

Continuous AI Assurance

Global Alignment

This blueprint is designed to align conceptually with governance principles reflected in internationally recognized frameworks, including:

- EU AI Act
- NIST AI Risk Management Framework (AI RMF)
- ISO/IEC 42001
- IIA Global Internal Audit Standards

Organizations should evaluate and implement this blueprint in accordance with applicable laws, regulations, contractual obligations, and organizational governance requirements within their respective jurisdictions.

Pakistan Alignment

The blueprint is intended to support organizations in considering Pakistan's evolving AI governance landscape alongside applicable corporate governance, privacy, cybersecurity, and regulatory expectations where relevant.

Implementation should be based on applicable legal requirements, regulatory guidance, and organizational policies in force at the time of deployment.

Limitations

This blueprint:

- Does not replace laws or regulations.
- Does not replace Internal Audit Standards.
- Does not replace legal advice.
- Does not replace professional judgment.
- Should be adapted to each organization's governance structure, regulatory environment, and risk appetite.

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THE FUTURIST'S STRATEGY CONE™ is an original governance framework developed by **Adnan Shamim.**

Version History

V1.0 – Initial conceptual model

V2.0 – Operational governance blueprint

V3.0 – Enterprise Governance Blueprint
(Technology-Neutral Edition)

Legal Disclaimer

This blueprint is an independent conceptual governance framework developed for educational, research, and professional discussion purposes.

It does not constitute legal advice, regulatory guidance, auditing standards, certification criteria, or professional assurance.

Organizations should seek appropriate legal, regulatory, technical, and professional advice before implementation and adapt the framework to applicable laws, regulations, contractual obligations, and internal governance requirements.

Final Governance Principle

**AI Enhances Capability. Humans Maintain
Accountability.**

AI Works. Humans Decide.



**AGENTIC AI
DRIVEN FUTURE**

THE STRENGTH OF A FUTURE-READY STRATEGIC MODEL



**HUMAN JUDGMENT.
AI ENHANCEMENT.
ACCOUNTABILITY.**

A powerful framework is not just a set of steps —
it is an **intelligent architecture** that connects the **present state** with the **future vision**.

THE FUTURIST'S STRATEGY CONE™

A Connected Architecture for Vision, Strategy, Risk & Execution

THE CORE STRENGTH:

The strength of The Futurist's Strategy Cone™ lies in its ability to create alignment:



VISION

Defines the future state and the direction an organization wants to achieve.



STRATEGY

Converts that vision into clear priorities, choices, and strategic decisions.



OPERATING MODEL

Connects people, processes, technology, governance, and capabilities into one integrated system.



EXECUTION

Transforms strategy into action through implementation, monitoring, and continuous improvement.



RISK AS THE CONNECTING INTELLIGENCE

Links objectives, processes, controls, compliance, and improvement cycles into a unified view.



OBJECTIVES



PROCESSES



CONTROLS



COMPLIANCE



ASSURANCE



IMPROVEMENT



THE REAL POWER OF A FRAMEWORK

appears when it can handle complexity and turn it into opportunity.

**THE FUTURE BELONGS
TO MODELS THAT DO
NOT JUST MANAGE
TODAY—BUT HELP
DESIGN TOMORROW.**



HANDLING COMPLEXITY. DRIVING ALIGNMENT.

A modern organization faces multiple challenges at the same time:



BUSINESS
TRANSFORMATION



RISK
MANAGEMENT



REGULATORY
EXPECTATIONS



TECHNOLOGY
EVOLUTION



AI-DRIVEN
CHANGE



Like a strong foundation that can support different structures, a well-designed framework provides the **architecture** to guide organizations through changing environments.

A strong strategic model does not treat these as separate problems. It creates a connected view where every element supports the other.



CREATOR OF AI FRAMEWORK ADNAN SHAMIM

Agentic AI Leader | Internal Audit & AI Governance Professional

Helping organizations govern Agentic AI through practical Audit, Risk, Evidence, Reporting & Internal Control frameworks.



THE FUTURIST'S STRATEGY CONE™

AI-POWERED. HUMAN-GOVERNED.
FUTURE-READY.



Built for the future.
Grounded in governance.



AI enhances capability.
Humans maintain accountability.



Designed for any organization.
Relevant in every industry.

A CONNECTED STRATEGY. INTELLIGENT GOVERNANCE. SUSTAINABLE FUTURE.